

Summer A Edu-498 Literacy as Social Practice Learners

Greetings my **Summer A** Edu-498 Literacy as Social Practice Learners,

I'm looking forward to building our learning community together. As you may know, this course will be condensed into a **6-week format** with **12 class sessions (from 15)**, during this semester we will meet **Tuesdays and Thursdays from May 19th until June 25th**. This course is fully online and we will engage in a combination of **Synchronous and Asynchronous** Learning during our short but jam-packed semester.

While I finalize adjustments to the syllabus based on feedback from the spring cohort, I wanted to offer you a way to **get a head start** on our most important reading.

We will be reading the entire book:

Cultivating Genius: An Equity Framework for Culturally and Historically Responsive Literacy

by **Gholdy Muhammad**

This text anchors our course and serves as the foundation for your **final project**: developing a mini-unit grounded in Muhammad's equity framework.

To Prepare in Advance:

As you read, I encourage you to:

- **Take notes** on major ideas, insights, and frameworks
- **Pull out 1–2 resonant quotes per chapter**—ones that spark ideas, challenge your thinking, or inspire action
- **Write down questions** you have or things you're curious to unpack further
- **Make 1–2 connections per chapter** to your current or future practice as an educator

These early reflections will support your participation, deepen your engagement during discussions, and serve as a springboard for your final project.

I will provide early access to the course materials and revised syllabus Tuesday, May 12th, 1 week prior to the start of the semester. Given the reading-intensive nature of this course, I want you to have ample time to engage with the materials before we begin.

Feel free to reach out if you have any questions in the meantime. I'm excited for what we'll build together this summer!

Warm regards,

Alyse